“Since the world is ending, planning for the future doesn’t matter.”

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that the end is so near that education, savings, or careers are pointless. Discouragement or hopelessness about the world. Using the end times as a reason to avoid responsibility. Past predictions that led people to quit jobs or sell homes. Feeling that only “spiritual” activities matter.

What Scripture teaches

Christ will return, but no one knows when. Until then, Scripture calls us to faithful, ordinary lives. In Jesus’ parable, the master told his servants, “Conduct business with this until I return.” Paul told believers to live quietly and work with their hands, and he corrected those who stopped working because they expected the end. God told exiles to build houses, plant gardens, and seek the good of their city. Our labor in the Lord is not in vain.

> *“Beforehand, he called ten of his servants and gave them ten minas. ‘Conduct business with this until I return,’ he said”* **(Luke 19:13)**.

Also see

> “And to aspire to live quietly, to attend to your own matters, and to work with your own hands, as we instructed you. Then you will behave properly toward outsiders, without being dependent on anyone” **(1 Thessalonians 4:11–12)**.

> “‘Build houses and settle down. Plant gardens and eat their produce. Take wives and have sons and daughters. Take wives for your sons and give your daughters in marriage, so that they too may have sons and daughters. Multiply there; do not decrease. Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper.’” **(Jeremiah 29:5–7)**.

> “Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast and immovable. Always excel in the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain” **(1 Corinthians 15:58)**.

> “Walk in the manner of the ant, O slacker; observe its ways and become wise. Without a commander, without an overseer or ruler, it prepares its provisions in summer; it gathers its food at harvest” **(Proverbs 6:6–8)**.

Common self-statements

- Why plan when the world is ending?
- Saving money is pointless.
- Education and careers don’t matter anymore.
- I don’t need to take care of my health or future.
- Only spiritual things are worth doing now.
- There’s no point in starting anything long-term.

Common logical errors

- **Fortune telling:** Assuming you know the end is too close to plan.

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing only spiritual activities matter.
- **Avoidance:** Using the end times as a reason to avoid responsibility.
- **Discounting Scripture:** Overlooking commands to work faithfully until Christ returns.

Challenging questions

- What did the master tell his servants to do until he returned?
- What did Paul tell believers who stopped working?
- What did God tell the exiles in Babylon to do?
- Does Scripture say my labor is in vain?
- Who would be affected if I stopped planning: my family, my future self?
- Is this belief helping me be faithful or helping me avoid something?
- What faithful plan could I make this week?

Truth summary

> Planning for the future still matters. Jesus will return, but until then He calls me to be faithful with what He has given me. Work, savings, education, health, and relationships are part of faithful living. My labor in the Lord is not in vain, and I can plan wisely while trusting God with the timing.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Plans
- Occupation/Job/Work
- Money
- Laziness
- End Times

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Since the world is ending, planning for the future doesn't matter"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Since the world is ending, planning for the future doesn't matter." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did the master tell his servants?
- ☐ What did Paul tell those who stopped working?
- ☐ What did God tell the exiles?
- ☐ Is my labor in vain?
- ☐ Who would be affected if I stopped planning?
- ☐ What faithful plan could I make this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus calls me to be faithful until He returns.
- ☐ Planning wisely is part of faithful living.
- ☐ My labor in the Lord is not in vain.
- ☐ I can seek the good of the place where I live.
- ☐ I can work, save, and grow while trusting God.
- ☐ God holds the timing; I hold today's responsibilities.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Luke 19:13**
  "Beforehand, he called ten of his servants and gave them ten minas. 'Conduct business with this until I return,' he said."
- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 4:11–12**
  "And to aspire to live quietly, to attend to your own matters, and to work with your own hands, as we instructed you. Then you will behave properly toward outsiders, without being dependent on anyone."
- [ ] **Jeremiah 29:5–7**
  "'Build houses and settle down. Plant gardens and eat their produce. Take wives and have sons and daughters. Take wives for your sons and give your daughters in marriage, so that they too may have sons and daughters. Multiply there; do not decrease. Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper.'"
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 15:58**
  "Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast and immovable. Always excel in the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain."
- [ ] **Proverbs 6:6–8**
  "Walk in the manner of the ant, O slacker; observe its ways and become wise. Without a commander, without an overseer or ruler, it prepares its provisions in summer; it gathers its food at harvest."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Faithful steward log:** Each day, write one responsible step I took for my future or my family.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Corinthians 15:58 becomes: "Therefore, **Sarah**, be steadfast and immovable. Always excel in the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Plans" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio download.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Make one practical plan this week:** a budget, a savings goal, a class, or a health appointment.
- ☐ **Read Luke 19:11–27,** and write what the faithful servants did while their master was away.
- ☐ **Read Jeremiah 29:4–7,** and write one way you can seek the good of your community.
- ☐ **Talk with a wise Christian** about balancing hope in Christ's return with planning.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Since the world is ending, planning for the future doesn't matter": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One responsible step for my future
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Since the world is ending, planning for the future doesn't matter.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for the hope of Christ's return. Help me reject the lie that planning for the future doesn't matter because the world is ending. Make me a faithful steward of my time, work, money, and relationships until Jesus comes. In His name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.